AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XII

ANNUAL EXAMINATIONS (THEORY) 2024

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours 5 minutes Marks: 60

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INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's Signature**

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2. There are FOUR questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 3 offers TWO choices and Question 4 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use a black pointer to write your answers. DO NOT write your answers in pencil.
   DO NOT use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only. DO NOT write outside the answer box.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 17 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and then answer all the questions that follow:

Text A

The Great Resignation is an idea proposed by Professor Anthony Klotz of Texas A&M University that predicts many people leaving their jobs after the COVID pandemic ends and life returns to 'normal'. Managers are now navigating the ripple effects from the pandemic, as employees re-evaluate their careers and leave their jobs in record numbers.

At the onset of the pandemic, the job market was full of uncertainty and mass layoffs: millions of people lost their jobs, and those lucky enough to remain employed remained put in their roles for survival. However, as we now turn towards recovery, workers in privileged positions who don't live paycheck to paycheck are now finally moving on. Most [employees] in non-developed economies with the absence of social security and unemployment benefits cannot afford this luxury but may still be undergoing duress and pent-up frustration from the disruption caused by the pandemic.

These trends highlight the importance to understanding why people are leaving and what can be done to prevent 'The Great Resignation'. It also calls for a data-driven approach to determine not just how many people are quitting, but who exactly has the highest turnover risk…

The study of organisations is fascinating because many things we hold dear are the result and product of organisations and the leadership therein. When things don't work out, when services fail, or products lack a certain quality – it is all the result of organisational failure…

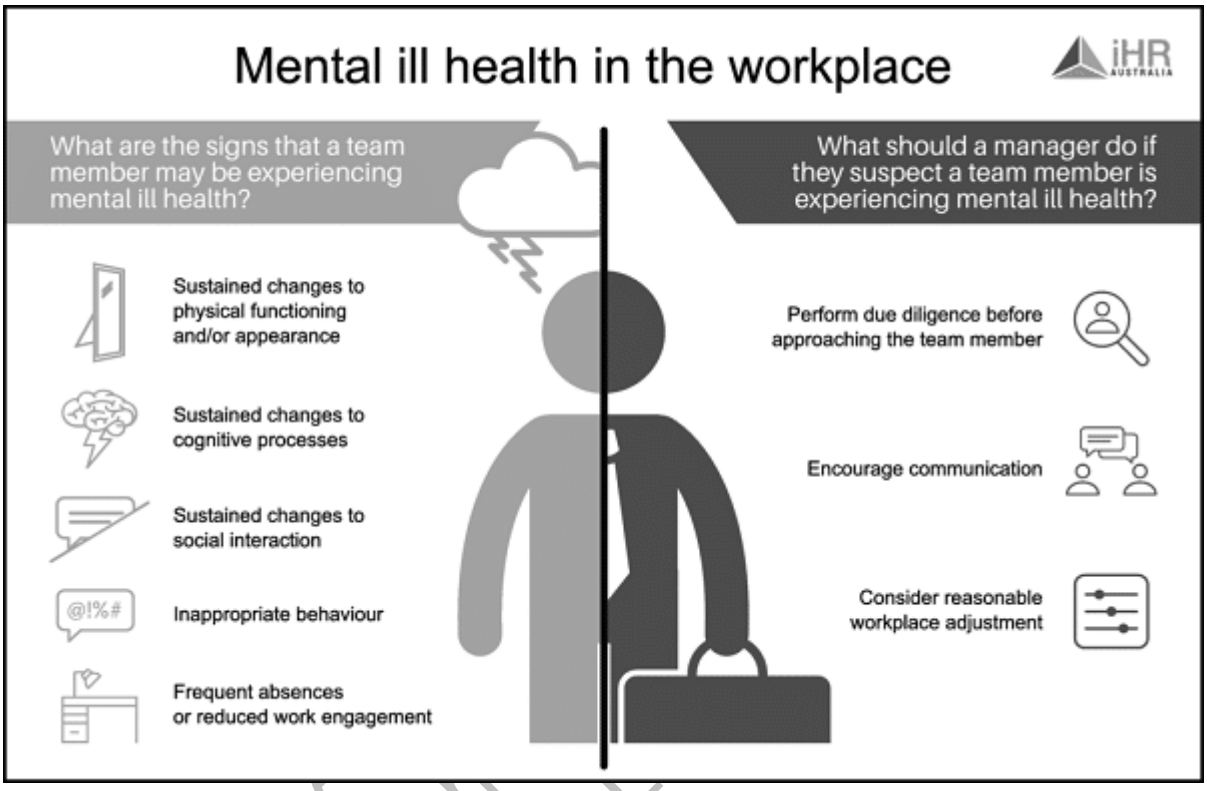
We have yet to see what a post pandemic world and workplace will look like. What we can already see is that how we organise work and work together will not return to the way it was before the pandemic. Many companies have announced that their employees never have to return to the office fulltime…I expect that companies will allow a part of their workforce to work fully remote most of the time and allow another part of their workforce to come to the office only on 1-2 days a week…This new way of organising work requires a different leadership style also demands new skills from workers. Self-leadership will gradually replace leadership through leaders and control…

During the pandemic, some of the most popular employers have announced that their workers never have to come back into the office regularly again, so it certainly will become an issue of employer attractiveness. There are many benefits of remote working, as employers can save on real estate costs and tap into global talent flexibly. The degree of remote work will also depend upon how well firms manage the challenges that come with remote work…Overall, virtual and remote work is mostly here to stay…

Source: Adapted from '*What is 'The Great Resignation'?*' as published on https://www.weforum.org

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Text B



Source: Taken from iHR Australia

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a. If you were the author of Text A, what TWO aspects would you have added in the Text? Provide a reason for each aspect. (4 Marks)

b. By referring to Text A,

i. describe the author's opinion on working remotely. Provide a textual reference to support your answer. (3 Marks)

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ii. do you think that remote work is the future of doing business or networking? Give THREE reasons to support your answer. (3 Marks)

c. With reference to the information presented in Text B, state any FOUR ways in which people's mental health is negatively affected in the workplace. (4 Marks)

d. Draw any THREE differences between Text A and Text B. (3 Marks)

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Q.2. (Total 10 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and fill in each of the blanks with **ONE** suitable word.

Considered among the oldest towers in the world and (1) _____ of the symbols of Istanbul, Galata Tower was included in the UNESCO World Heritage Temporary List in 2013…

Galata Tower (2) _____ first built by the Byzantine Emperor Justinianos in 507-508 AD. The ancient Tower of Galata…stood on the north side of the Golden Horn in Istanbul and located (3) _____ the citadel of Galata. The tower then marked the northern end of the great chain, which was expanded across the mouth of the Golden Horn to prevent enemy ships from entering the harbour…

The Genoese rebuilt the current tower in 1348-49. When the Genoans captured Galata in the 1300s…Ultimately, (4) _____ repaired all the walls and bastions. They also rebuilt the Galata Tower, located at the top of the walls, and (5) _____ the foundations of today's tower.

Galata Tower was built in (6) _____ masonry rubble stone system. The exterior is stone mesh…The round arched window above the door was the lookout for the soldiers. It is a nine-story (7) _____ after the high ground floor.

Today, it (8) _____ observed (9) _____ the part of the building up to the third floor has a Genoese character and the other floors (10) _____an Ottoman character. The building used today is re-established as a museum…

Source: Adapted from an article on Galata Tower, Istanbul, Turkiye as published on https://muze.gen.tr/muze-detay/galatakulesi

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Q.3. (Total 15 Marks)

Compose a formal piece of writing of around 250-300 words on any **ONE** of the options **a** or **b**.

EITHER

a. You had gone for a two-month internship programme to a non-governmental organisation (NGO) in your city that aims to raise awareness on child labour. The manager of the organisation has tasked you to collect information or data about the number of children working in the city.

Write a report to the manager on the given task. In your report,

- discuss a key finding of your research.
- suggest TWO strategies to raise awareness on child labour.
- mention a challenge you faced during information gathering.

OR

b. A local television agency has announced the following vacancies with requirements in the given job advertisement.



Compose a covering letter and a résumé for any one of the vacancies given in the advertisement. In your covering letter, discuss

- how your previous experience will help you in the role that you have chosen.
- TWO reasons why your management style will be best suited for the role.
- how you will add value to the agency.

Note: In your covering letter and résumé, write points other than the ones mentioned in the advertisement.

Make your notes on the pages given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 8, 9 and 10.

Option _____

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Q.4. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 350-400 words on any **ONE** of the options **a, b** or **c.**
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. Compose an essay (real or imagined) about your first meeting with your best friend. In your essay, describe

- your first impression of your friend.
- TWO reasons why you considered befriending him/ her.
- TWO lessons that your best friend has taught you.

OR

b. According to World Economic Forum's Global Gender Gap Report 2022, Pakistan ranks 145th out of 146 countries. This is because women make up less than 20% of the workforce (labour force) in the country.

With reference to the given information, compose an essay on improving the representation of women in the workforce. In your essay,

- examine TWO reasons behind the low percentage of women in the country's workforce.
- discuss THREE strategies for increasing the number of women in the workforce.

OR

c. Societal pressure is the expectation of the society towards an individual. This pressure affects their personal and professional lives, often at the cost of their mental health.

Write an essay on the given issue. In your essay, discuss

- how can societal pressure affects a person's personal and/ or professional life.
- THREE ways to deal with societal pressure.

Make your notes on the pages given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 12, 13 and 14.

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END OF PAPER

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